ERA 5

America on the World Stage

1812 – 1825

The War of 1812 · the Era of Good Feelings · nationalism vs. sectionalism

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the War of 1812 and its aftermath fuel both a surge of nationalism and deepening sectional divisions?

KEY TERMS

War of 1812 · Treaty of Ghent · Monroe Doctrine · American System · Missouri Compromise · Era of Good Feelings

ALIGNED TO

CED Topics 4.3–4.4 · AMSCO Ch. 4.3–4.4

AMERICA'S SECOND WAR WITH BRITAIN

The War of 1812

Why War Came

I

Impressment

Britain seized U.S. sailors and forced them into its navy.

II

War Hawks

Young leaders like **Clay** and **Calhoun** demanded war.

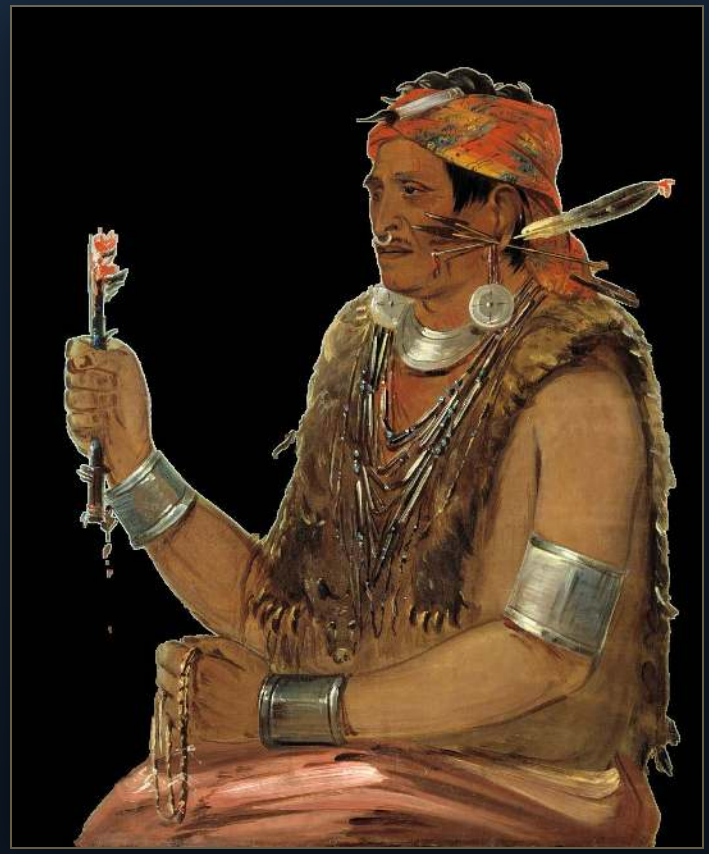
III

The Frontier

Settlers blamed Britain for arming Native resistance in the West.

Tecumseh's Confederacy

- Shawnee brothers **Tecumseh** and the Prophet united tribes to resist expansion.
- General **William Henry Harrison** crushed them at the **Battle of Tippecanoe**.
- British support for Native nations pushed America toward war.



The War of 1812



- The British **burned Washington, D.C.**—including the White House.
- The defense of Fort McHenry inspired the **Star-Spangled Banner**.
- The war ended in stalemate with the **Treaty of Ghent** (1814).

A War That Forged a Nation

SURVIVAL

Second Independence

Having survived Britain again, the U.S. wins respect.

→

PRIDE

Rising Nationalism

A surge of American national feeling follows the war.

→

COLLAPSE

End of the Federalists

The antiwar Hartford Convention destroys the party.

SECTION

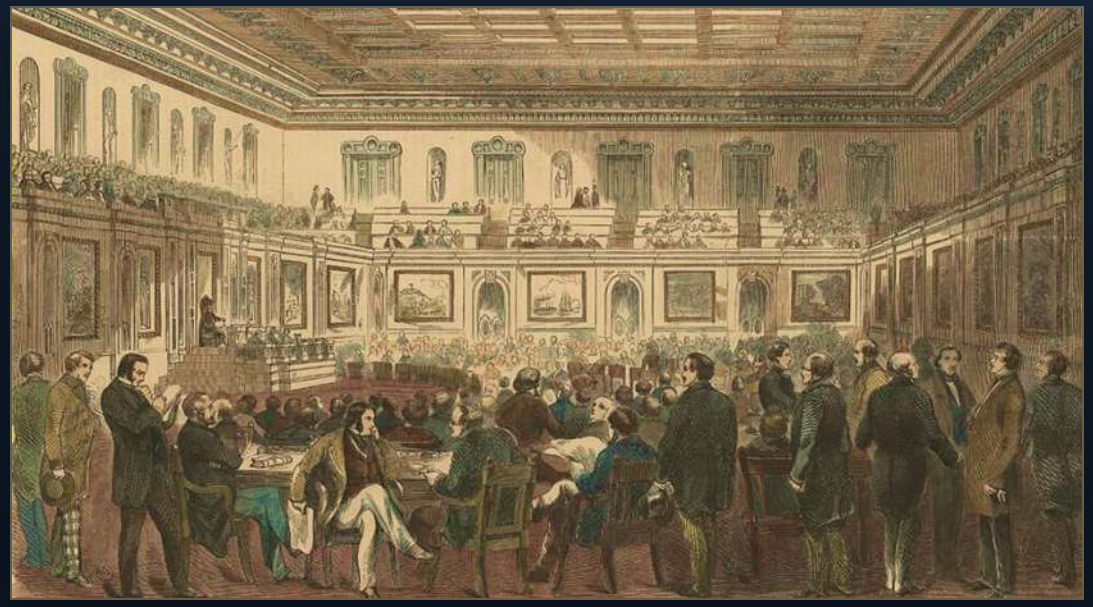
America on the World Stage

Florida & the Adams–Onís Treaty

- Andrew **Jackson** stormed into Spanish **Florida** in 1818.
- In the **Adams-Onís Treaty** (1819), Spain ceded **Florida** to the U.S.
- The nation's borders pushed to the Pacific.



The Monroe Doctrine, 1823



- President Monroe warned Europe against new colonies in the Americas.
- The Western Hemisphere was 'off-limits' to European interference.
- The **Monroe Doctrine** announced America's arrival as a hemispheric power.

THE ERA OF GOOD FEELINGS?

Nationalism & Sectionalism

Clay's American System

A blueprint to bind the nation's economy together—though regions disagreed over who benefited

I

Protective Tariff

Taxes on imports to shield American manufacturing.

II

National Bank

A second **Bank of the United States** to steady credit and currency.

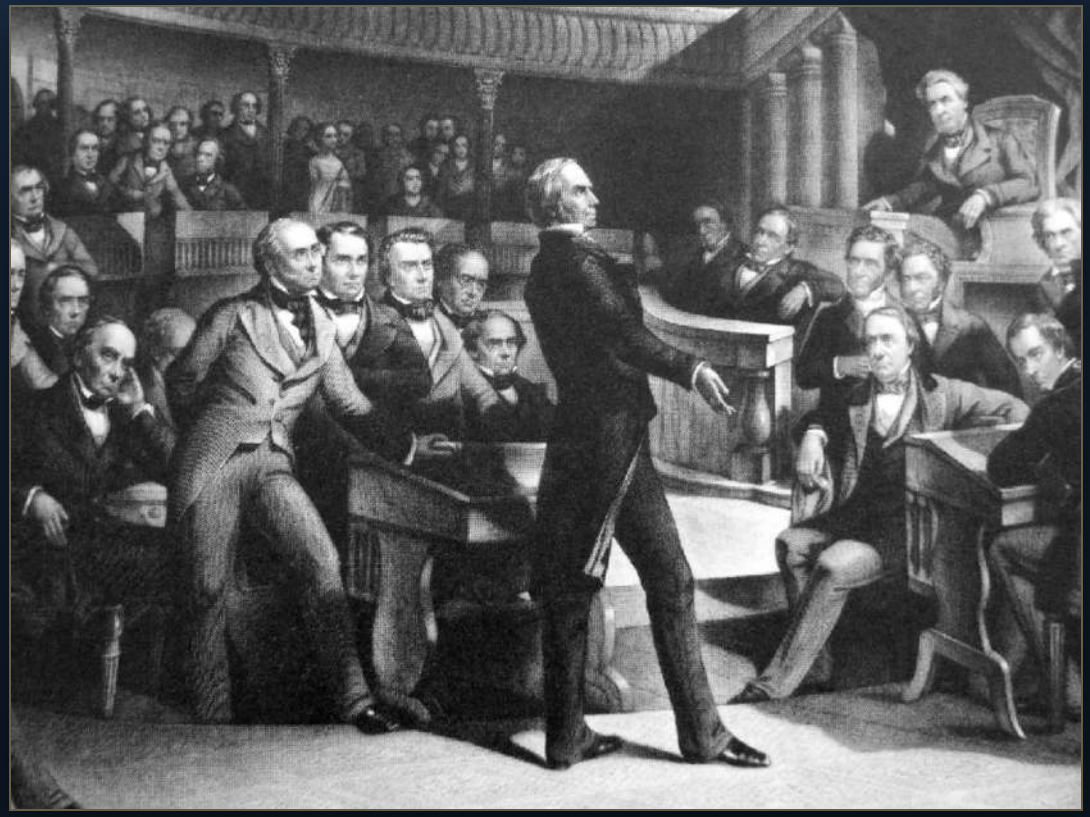
III

Internal Improvements

Federally funded roads and canals to link the regions.

The Missouri Compromise, 1820

- Missouri's bid for statehood threatened the balance of free and slave states.
- **Henry Clay** brokered a deal: Missouri slave, Maine free.
- Slavery was banned north of the 36°30′ line in the Louisiana Territory.



An Era of Good Feelings?

Surging Nationalism

Forces of unity

- A one-party '**Era of Good Feelings**.'
- The **American System** and the **Monroe Doctrine**.
- National pride after surviving the **War of 1812**.

Rising Sectionalism

Forces of division

- The tariff pitted North against South.
- The **Missouri Compromise** exposed the rift over slavery.
- 'A firebell in the night'—Jefferson's warning.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

America on the World Stage

1. The **War of 1812**—driven by **impressment**, **war hawks**, and frontier conflict—ended in stalemate but sparked **nationalism** and doomed the Federalists.

2. The U.S. asserted itself abroad through the **Adams-Onís Treaty** and the **Monroe Doctrine**.

3. Beneath the **'Era of Good Feelings,' sectionalism** grew—the **Missouri Compromise** revealed the deepening divide over slavery, even as Clay's **American System** sought unity.

DISCUSS & APPLY

America on the World Stage

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

COMPARISON

How did the same postwar moment produce both **nationalism** (Monroe Doctrine, American System) and **sectionalism** (Missouri Compromise)?

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

Was the **"Era of Good Feelings"** an accurate label? Explain what continued and what changed.

CAUSATION

Explain how the **War of 1812** caused both a surge of nationalism and the collapse of the Federalist Party.

Up next — **Milestone Assessment** (cumulative test, Eras 1–5)